COURSE

## AQA A-level Business (7132)

# Improving motivation and engagement

**3.6 Human resource management · 3.6.4 Making human resource decisions: improving motivation and engagement**

Revision for 3.6 Human resource management: each firm works it out on its own deals.

| Class | Topic |
|---|---|
| **AQA A-level Business (7132)** | **Improving motivation and engagement** |

THE LESSON

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Setup** | | | | | 2 min |
| **Round 1** | | | | | Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min |
| **Firm decisions** | **Deals** | TASK 1 Herzberg: hygiene | TASK 2 Staff feel ignored | | |
| **Round 2** | | | | | Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 2 min |
| **Firm decisions** | **Deals** | TASK 3 Maslow in order | TASK 4 Piece-rate pay | **B2B deal** | |
| **Round 3** | | | | | Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 2 min |
| **Firm decisions** | **Deals** | TASK 5 Pay or promotion | TASK 6 Maslow: next need | **B2B deal** | |
| **Final questions** | | | | | 3 min |

45-minute setting shown. The 30-minute setting has one topic task per round (Tasks 3, 5 and 6) and one B2B deal. 60 and 75 add more deals.

# Each step

| | |
|---|---|
| **Firm decisions** | Each role makes its decision on its own page. |
| **Deals** | Each pupil trades with a classmate in another firm. |
| **Topic task** | The firm answers together. Everyone presses Agree. |
| **B2B deal** | One firm sells a lot of cars to another firm. |
| **Final questions** | Each pupil answers six questions. |

# Firm decisions

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **CEO** | **Staff** | Hire staff. Each costs a salary and gives one benefit. |
| | **Sabotage** FROM ROUND 2 | Hit a rival firm's cash, at a cost. A Legal Counsel blocks it. |
| **Sales & Marketing** | **Marketing** | Book one advert campaign to lift the next sales. |
| **Finance** | **Capital & Loans** | Borrow cash. The firm pays it back with interest. |
| | **Investments** | Buy property or funds. The value can rise or fall. |
| **Operations** | **Buying** | Hire the Procurement Specialist or the Stock Controller for the round. |

**B2B deal · Rounds 2 and 3**

One firm sells a lot of 3 cars to another firm (4 in Round 3). With an odd number of firms, two firms offer to sell and the lower price wins.

# Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same for every firm.

## Task 1

ROUND 1

You raise pay and fix the cold workshop. Complaints stop, but staff work no harder.

**Using Herzberg, why did output not rise?**

PICK ONE

- ✔ **Pay and conditions are hygiene factors**
- ○ Pay is a motivator, but too small
- ○ Staff need closer supervision
- ○ Staff's esteem needs are already met

**Why:** Hygiene factors remove dissatisfaction but do not motivate.

## Task 2

ROUND 1

A staff survey says pay is fine, but staff feel ignored.

**Which two changes should motivate most?**

PICK TWO

- ○ A 2% pay rise for all
- ○ A bonus for every car sold
- ✔ **Ask staff to help set targets**
- ○ Closer checks on their work
- ✔ **Let teams plan their own work**

**Why:** Feeling ignored is not about pay: involvement and trust tackle it.

## Task 3

ROUND 2

Maslow's hierarchy of needs, at your firm.

**Put the needs in order, lowest first?**

PUT THESE IN ORDER, FIRST TO LAST · RIGHT ORDER

1. **Physiological: pay for the basics**
2. **Safety: a secure contract**
3. **Social: a friendly team**
4. **Esteem: praise for good work**

**Why:** Maslow: physiological, safety, social, then esteem, then self-actualisation.

## Task 4

ROUND 2

Prep staff are paid per car finished.

**Her pay this week?**

WORK OUT THE NUMBER, THEN PICK IT · EXAMPLE FIGURES

| | |
|---|---|
| Pay per car prepared | **£16** |
| Cars she prepared this week | **46 cars** |
| Extra per car above 30 cars | **£5** |

METHOD

**Pay = cars × pay per car + cars above the target × extra**

46 × £16 + 16 × £5 = £816

**Why:** Piece rate pays for output, so staff work faster, sometimes at the cost of quality.

## Task 5

ROUND 3

Sales staff are leaving. Exit interviews say pay is fair, but there is no chance to progress.

**What should you offer, and why?**

PICK A OR B AND GIVE A REASON

- ○ A higher basic salary
- ✔ **Training and a clear promotion path**

**Why:** Pay is not the problem; a chance to grow and progress meets the need staff named.

## Task 6

ROUND 3

A technician has a secure, well-paid job and friends at work, but feels no one values her skill.

**Using Maslow, which need should you meet next?**

PICK ONE

- ✔ **Esteem needs**
- ○ Physiological needs
- ○ Safety needs
- ○ Social needs

**Why:** Safety and social needs are met; recognition is an esteem need, which comes next.

# Final questions

**6**
questions for each pupil

**109**
Level 3 Business questions

**0**
of them on improving motivation and engagement

**No question in the pool is about improving motivation and engagement yet. The game draws 6 of the 109 Level 3 questions.**